

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Musharraf Khan

Address: 101 Brocks Drive North Cheam SM3 9UW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my support for Planning Application DM2025/01591. I am a local resident and have been part of this community since 2018. As someone familiar with the neighbourhood and its needs, I believe this proposal represents a positive and thoughtful addition to the area.

I would also like to share my personal experience. I attend activities organised by the community leaders with my children, and they thoroughly enjoy participating. These activities give them the opportunity to mix with local people from different backgrounds, build friendships, and feel part of the wider community. I have seen firsthand how beneficial this has been for their confidence and mental wellbeing. Having a dedicated, well-managed space for such programmes would only strengthen these positive outcomes for many more families.

In my view, the proposed Community Hub will deliver meaningful benefits to local residents. The plans include health and wellbeing programmes, community-use space, and inclusive facilities designed to serve a wide range of people from different ethnicities and backgrounds. The provision of dedicated activities and safe, welcoming space for women is particularly valuable, ensuring broader participation and engagement within the community. Additionally, the inclusion of educational programmes for children will provide structured learning, mentoring, and personal development opportunities that benefit families locally.

The building itself is modest in scale and in keeping with the character of the surrounding area. It does not appear overbearing or out of proportion with neighbouring properties. Compared to alternative forms of development that could be permitted on the site, this proposal represents a

low-intensity use that is community-focused rather than commercially driven.

Concerns regarding traffic and access have been carefully addressed in the plans. The provision of 12 on-site parking spaces, including 2 disabled bays, demonstrates consideration for accessibility and responsible parking management. The inclusion of cycle racks further promotes sustainable travel and encourages environmentally responsible transport choices. I also note that existing greenery is being maintained, which helps preserve the visual character of the site and contributes positively to the local environment.

In relation to Friday prayers, these generally finish before 2pm and therefore do not conflict with school pick-up times. This timing further reduces the likelihood of congestion during peak school traffic periods. Overall, I do not believe the development will result in significant traffic, light, or noise issues beyond what would normally be expected for a small-scale community facility.

For these reasons, I respectfully support Planning Application DM2025/01591. I believe it will provide valuable social, educational, and wellbeing benefits while remaining proportionate and considerate of the local area.

I kindly ask the Council to approve this application.